

1. ttok 1.0

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-10-09T00:34:43+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/9/ttok/>

Release: ttok 1.0 I released ttok 0.4 , ran uv tool upgrade ttok , piped a file into the new version... and realized that it was defaulting to the GPT-4 tokenizer when it should very clearly default to GPT-5/GPT-6 instead! I figured switching the default was a reasonable excuse to finally ship a 1.0. OpenAI haven't actually confirmed that GPT-6 uses the same tokenizer as the GPT-5 family yet - there's an angry issue about it - but I found this commit by William Liu which reports on an experiment he ran confirming that the tokenizers are likely the same: All seven GPT models (5.5, 5.6 Sol/Terra/Luna, 6 Astra/Sol/Luna) report 44,794 tokens and match each other on every one of the 31 fixtures. GPT-6 introduces no input-count change on this corpus. Tags: projects , ai , openai , generative-ai , llms , tokenization

2. ttok 0.4

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-10-08T23:34:28+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/8/ttok/>

Release: ttok 0.4 ttok is my CLI tool for counting tokens, using OpenAI's open source tiktoken library. It hasn't been updated in a couple of years, but I finally fixed a Click warning, updated CI, and added a --list-models command to list available models. It works with uvx , so you can count tokens in anything like this: cat file.txt | uvx ttok Tags: projects , ai , openai , generative-ai , llms , tokenization

3. Quoting Carson Gross

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-10-08T21:05:44+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/8/carson-gross/>

Computer programming is, fundamentally, about two things: Problem-solving using computers Learning to control complexity while solving these problems I have a hard time imagining a future where knowing how to solve problems with computers and how to control the complexity of those solutions is less valuable than it is today, so I think it will continue to be a viable career even with the advent of AI tools. ? Carson Gross Tags: computer-science , carson-gross , careers , ai

4. If one anti-malware software is good, does that make two better?

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Thu, 08 Oct 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20261008-00/?p=112762/>

Not always. The post If one anti-malware software is good, does that make two better? appeared first on The Old New Thing .

5. Let's Check In on Trump's Blog

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-08T22:52:35Z

Link: <https://truthsocial.com/@realDonaldTrump/posts/117406176604364910>

An actual post from the sitting president of the United States: The White House considers anyone that uses the term, ?Artificial Intelligence,? as opposed to the highly accepted new and more accurate term, ?Super Intelligence,? THE ENEMY! President DONALD J. TRUMP This, from the self-professed ? party of free speech ?. Trump's screws are so loose you can hear them rattling around. ?

6. Apple Is Slow-Rolling iOS 27 Adoption, So Far

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-08T19:30:36Z

Link: https://mastodon.social/@_Davidsmith/117355154519434137

David Smith, last week: Been really interesting to watch the iOS 27 adoption curve over the first two weeks. Clearly on a different path than previous years. Still steadily growing, at a

similar rate to the 'steady growth' phase of most years, but without the big surge at the start. Given that this rate is largely controlled by Apple's automatic update logic, I suspect it's a deliberate choice. Likely because it lets them manage the Siri AI waiting list and avoid a big queue on day one. Smith's numbers are from analytics from users of WidgetsSmith and Pedometer++. If you look at his chart for WidgetsSmith, there's really no explanation other than Apple pushing automatic updates to users more slowly than in any previous year, and I think it makes sense that this is to gate admissions to Siri AI. You can also see from his chart that Apple has been slowing down updates to initial .0 versions in recent years - the adoption rates were much faster for iOS 15 and 16 back in 2021 and 2022. Note too that every year Apple makes it more and more likely that users will opt into automatic software updates. The overwhelming majority of iOS users get OS updates when their devices update themselves...

7. Joz Announces 'Welcome Home' Keynote Coming Tuesday, 13 October

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-08T19:00:09Z

Link: <https://x.com/gregjoz/status/2108226096407994858>

It's almost like you can predict the timing of such things, if you pay attention to Apple's consistent patterns. ?

8. 20 Minutes of Political Debate, Brought to You by Commercial Breaks

Source: Software and Tech stories from an Insider - iDiallo.com | Published: Fri, 09 Oct 2026 04:59:23 GMT

Link: <https://idiallo.com/byte-size/20-minutes-of-political-debate>

"I'm sorry, you're out of time, we have to move on. Senator, what's your response? You have three minutes." Watching a political debate these days feels useless. Candidates get two minutes to make their case, and their opponents get even less time to reply. I'm reminded of *Amusing Ourselves to Death* by Neil Postman, where he argues that what passes for debate on TV is nothing more than an audition or a performance review. It is only an opportunity to come up with catchy sound bites or to appear likable. On the other hand, if you want long-form, one-sided podcasts where politicians can babble uninterrupted for hours without being challenged, you can tune into Joe Rogan, Lex Fridman, or whichever pseudo-comedian is trending. Our choices seem locked between traditional media, where you barely have time to clear your throat, and one-sided online echo chambers. So why not a third option? Two candidates sitting down in a long-form podcast format. Debate the issues, prove your point, and take turns. No commercial breaks required. If it takes three hours, it takes three hours. This format isn't new, in fact, it plagues social media right now. The problem is that it's mostly driven by infl...

9. Privacy policies and modal logic

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Thu, 08 Oct 2026 13:43:02 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/10/08/privacy-policies-and-modal-logic/>

If you've followed this blog for a while, you may know that I do a lot of work with data privacy and that I have an interest in modal logic. Recently these two worlds collided: I became aware of work that uses modal logic to reason about data privacy. The story begins with Helen Nissenbaum's [?] The post Privacy policies and modal logic first appeared on John D. Cook .

10. Theatre Review: Hay Fever at Wyndham's Theatre ?????

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Thu, 08 Oct 2026 11:34:40 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/10/theatre-review-hay-fever-at-wyndhams-theatre/>

I'm a theatrical cheapskate. I'm on all those last-minute seat-filler websites. I'll happily take a chance on an experimental play for a tenner a ticket or sit in an inexplicably unsold cheap seat at a major show. My philosophy is that the worst seat at the best show is preferable to the best seat at the worst show. But, once in a while, I'll splash out and pay full price. When the email landed?

11. The Rise and Fall of the Plasma Screen

Source: Construction Physics | Published: Thu, 08 Oct 2026 12:02:36 GMT

Link: <https://www.construction-physics.com/p/the-rise-and-fall-of-the-plasma-screen>

In 1960, a team at the University of Illinois released the first version of their PLATO ?computerized instruction system,? a network of what would eventually be thousands of computer terminals connected to large mainframe computers.

12. ?Getting off the Modernization Treadmill?

Source: Jim Nielsen?s Blog | Published: Thu, 08 Oct 2026 19:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://blog.jim-nielsen.com/2026/talk-notes-modernization-treadmill/>

My notes from this talk by Alexander Petros at Big Sky DevCon 2026 . Alex starts by noting how ?modernize? used to mean something along the lines of ?update this thing that was made before I was born?. But now ?modernize? means something more like ?update this thing from 5-10 years ago? (hence the framing of the talk, the ?modernization treadmill?). Using a real-world example of an incredibly slow website that was required to access state-sponsored programs for welfare, Alex points out the disparity in conditions between those of us who make software and those who have to use them: The people who develop these websites are usually doing so on high-powered internet connections and high-powered devices, but they're not using them in the conditions that the people who most need those benefits are going to be. Then he shows a Reddit thread where somebody essentially posted, ?I'm having problems with this website. I've been waiting for months for my application to go through. Any suggestions?? And one Reddit user responded, ?The best thing you can do is go into the physical office, get a case worker, and your problems will be solved within the hour.? The irony. I guess we've come full...

13. iFlac: Sync your FLAC files to your iPhone from Linux

Source: Jayden?s Blog | Published: 2026-10-08T18:33:00+00:00

Link: <https://jayd.ml/2026/10/08/iflac-sync-flacs-to-iphone.html>

COGNITOHazard WARNING: This README is written by a real life meat computer but the rest of the project is 100% vibecoded <https://github.com/jaydens-tasty-slop/iFlac> I have a growing FLAC collection that I'd like on my phone, but I don't want to have to boot Windows to use the Apple Music app or (shudders) iTunes. Had a friendly robot write this project to sync your FLAC files to your iPhone. Based off of: libimobiledevice and the approach ByeTunes It works by pairing your PC then injecting rows into Apple Music?s sqlite database (!!). Seems to work fine from my testing on an iPhone 12. TIP: Don't use Bluetooth or this whole exercise was pointless - Bluetooth will compress your delicious lossless audio.

14. Get Player Stats From Your Minecraft Server Logs

Source: Jayden?s Blog | Published: 2026-10-08T18:26:00+00:00

Link: <https://jayd.ml/2026/10/08/minecraft-log-analyzer.html>

NOTE: The subject of this post was vibecoded, but this post is 100% written by a real life human being I have a Minecraft server with about 6 years of logs (covid minecraft server baby!) and I always wondered who has played the most and when, so I had a friendly robot slop together a little go app you can run on a cronjob to generate an HTML report. For a demo of the report, see here: <https://jaydens-tasty-slop.github.io/minecraft-log-analyzer/> Here?s the repo: <https://github.com/jaydens-tasty-slop/minecraft-log-analyzer> It saves events it parses out of the logs into a sqlite database, then incrementally parses new files daily if you run it in a cronjob. Features Server Stats: Total unique players Total play time in hours Play time by year Play time by player Player Stats: Play time (hours) (and by year) Play time with other players (see who plays with who) Sessions Time played Social time (with at least 1 other player on) Loner time (playing alone) Longest, shortest, and average session Longest, shortest, and minimum in-game lifetime Deaths Chat messages / commands Previous aliases Chat Messages: By default there is also a chat log rendered (but not linked to from other pages) Pa...

15. Swemak: Colemak for Swedish

Source: Entropic Thoughts | Published: Thu, 08 Oct 2026 00:00:00 +0200

Link: <https://entropicthoughts.com/swemak>

I have written before about my Swedish Colemak hack, but I never explained what makes it so good. This is a better image what it looks like: If you're struggling to find the difference against normal Colemak, look at the cluster of five keys next to the return key. This layout makes room for the three Swedish letters `ˆ`, `˜`, and `Ö` by only changing five keys in total, and they have changed very thoughtfully: (Continue reading the full article on the web.)

16. Let's Deconstruct Photoshop

Source: Tedium: The Dull Side of the Internet. | Published: 2026-10-08T16:54:14Z

Link: <https://feed.tedium.co/link/15204/17492299/artcraft-vibe-coding-creative-cloud-remake>

A quixotic new project takes an AI-first approach to battling Adobe, and while it's unclear where it leads, it raises important questions about what happens when companies ignore their users.